

The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, JULY 21, 2025

Prosecutions for unlawful reentry spike

US attorney targets immigrants who return to Mass. after being deported

By Shelley Murphy
and Neena Hagen

GLOBE STAFF

Federal prosecutors have charged a record number of people in Massachusetts with unlawfully reentering the United States after previously being deported as part of the Trump administration's immigration crackdown.

Since President Trump took office on Jan. 20 and through mid-July, prosecutors have filed unlawful

reentry charges against 105 people in US District Court in Massachusetts — some who arrived within the past year and others who reentered years, or even decades, ago, court records show. That surpasses the number of such cases brought in an entire year during Trump's first term and in any given year under both the Biden and Obama administrations.

"The president was clear that this was going to be a priority and

87
the number of illegal reentry cases brought in 2015 during President Obama's second term

82
cases in 2018, during President Trump's first term

105
unlawful reentry charges since President Trump took office on Jan. 20 and through mid-July in US District Court in Massachusetts

has been," said US Attorney Leah B. Foley, who was appointed by Trump in January. She said she has tapped every prosecutor in the office, from all units, to handle the unlawful reentry cases and will personally prosecute some herself.

The act of entering the country without authorization is considered a misdemeanor under federal law, and it has largely been treated by federal officials as a civil matter. But federal prosecutors can and do bring the more serious felony charges in cases in which someone reentered the country after they were al-

UNLAWFUL REENTRY, Page A7

Push for food leads to chaos, deaths

Gazan officials say dozens killed when Israeli troops open fire near UN convoy

By Aaron Boxerman, Isabel Kershner,
and Ameera Harouda

NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — Israeli forces killed and wounded dozens of Palestinians on Sunday in the northern Gaza Strip as crowds gathered near a border crossing where United Nations trucks were entering the enclave with humanitarian aid, according to the Gaza Health Ministry and local health workers.

A convoy of 25 trucks from the World Food Program, a United Nations agency, was crossing into Gaza and "encountered large crowds of civilians anxiously waiting to access desperately needed food supplies," the agency wrote in a statement Sunday. It said, "As the convoy approached, the surrounding crowd came under fire from Israeli tanks, snipers, and other gunfire."

It was the latest in a string of episodes in which Palestinians lost their lives as they gathered to get food. Hunger and desperation have gripped Palestinians in Gaza during Israel's nearly two-year military campaign against Hamas.

The shooting Sunday took place "despite assurances from Israeli authorities" that conditions for humanitarian operations would improve, "including that armed forces will not be present nor en-

MIDEAST, Page A5

N.H. pays price for compliance to Trump's cuts

Ayotte declines to join suits filed by other states

By Tal Kopan

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When schools across the country got word last month that the Trump administration was withholding billions of dollars in congressionally approved funds for public education, there was a familiar partisan split. Democrat-led states quickly sued; Republican-led states did not.

In New England, New Hampshire is the only state that has opted out of fighting for the funds in court, meaning that even if the other states' lawsuit is successful, the Granite State's schools would still lack millions in funding.

In the recent past, GOP-led states could sometimes benefit from the work of Democratic attorneys general when judges blocked such policies nationwide. But the Supreme Court in June ruled that lower court judges can almost never give their injunctions nationwide force, making such instances much less likely.

INJUNCTIONS, Page A7



MARK STOCKWELL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Fe Guidry, a personal care assistant, combed the hair of her client Aquilina Gili, 91, in Gili's New Bedford apartment.

FAMILIES NAVIGATE TATTERED SAFETY NET

Tax breaks and benefits cuts likely to widen divide between rich and poor

By Katie Johnston

GLOBE STAFF

Christopher Talbot, a full-time server at a pizzeria in Springfield, uses his monthly SNAP benefits to buy nutritious food for his family; he and his wife and two young daughters rely on Medicaid for health care.

But now that cuts to both these federal assistance programs have been signed into law by President Trump, Talbot is worried. Will he still be able to afford fresh fruits and vegetables? Will he have to work even longer

hours?

The story is sharply different for business owners who employ people like Talbot — especially the billionaires and private equity firms behind major companies such as Amazon, Walmart, and Dunkin', who stand to benefit greatly from tax breaks in the same piece of legislation.

Trump's so-called Big Beautiful Bill made historic reductions in programs that provide critical assistance for low-income families, stripping about \$186 billion from SNAP and

\$1 trillion from Medicaid over the next 10 years, according to preliminary estimates. The bill also includes \$4.5 trillion in tax cuts during that time, which will keep substantial income gains for the country's highest earners.

All told, this legislation will increase the divide between rich and poor, advocates say, as well as the wealth gap between white residents and people of color. And low-income workers, who make up the majority of people

BENEFITS, Page A10

The day the music revived

Reprise of iconic Porter Square bar sounds hopeful note for bleak club scene

By Danny McDonald

GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — The stage is so small, the musical trio can't all fit on it.

There's enough room for the guitarist, a drum kit, and some amps, but bassist and singer Clifford Carraha has to set up his mic stand a step down, on the floor of the actual club, before the band rips through some jams and covers of Frank Zappa and The Doors.

It's a Friday night at Toad, a tiny music club where coziness is the point. There are maybe 20 here taking in the JP Faundez Power Trio. The place has a capacity of 72.

It reopened earlier this year, after a year-and-a-half closure, according to the venue's owners. In doing so, it became something of an anomaly in Greater Boston.

As beloved, small venues have gone by the wayside in recent years — places like Thunder Road, Bull McCabe's, and Johnny D's Uptown Restaurant and Music Club in Somerville, Great Scott in All-

TOAD, Page A10



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Toad — capacity 72 — can play a big role in the development of music talent.


Chasing clouds away

Monday: Lots of sun, breezy.
High 76-81, low 57-62.

Tuesday: More of the same.
High 72-77, low 60-65.

Sunrise: 5:26. Sunset: 8:15.

Weather and comics, **D4-5**.

Obituaries, **C9**.

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VOL. 308, NO. 21

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



A group of Boston parents sued the school district once more over the admissions process to exams schools. **B1**.

About 30,000 jobs could be lost in the state as federal incentives for clean energy development evaporates. **D1**.

Syria's Bedouin clans said they had withdrawn from the Druze-majority city of Sweida following weeklong clashes and a US-brokered cease-fire. **A4**.

The Red Sox salvaged the final game in their series with the Cubs, riding the early stellar effort of pitcher Garrett Crochet and a late barrage of home runs. **C1**.

The number of missing people from floods in a battered Texas county dropped from nearly 100 to 3. **A2**.

Ukraine once more pushes for cease-fire. **A4**.